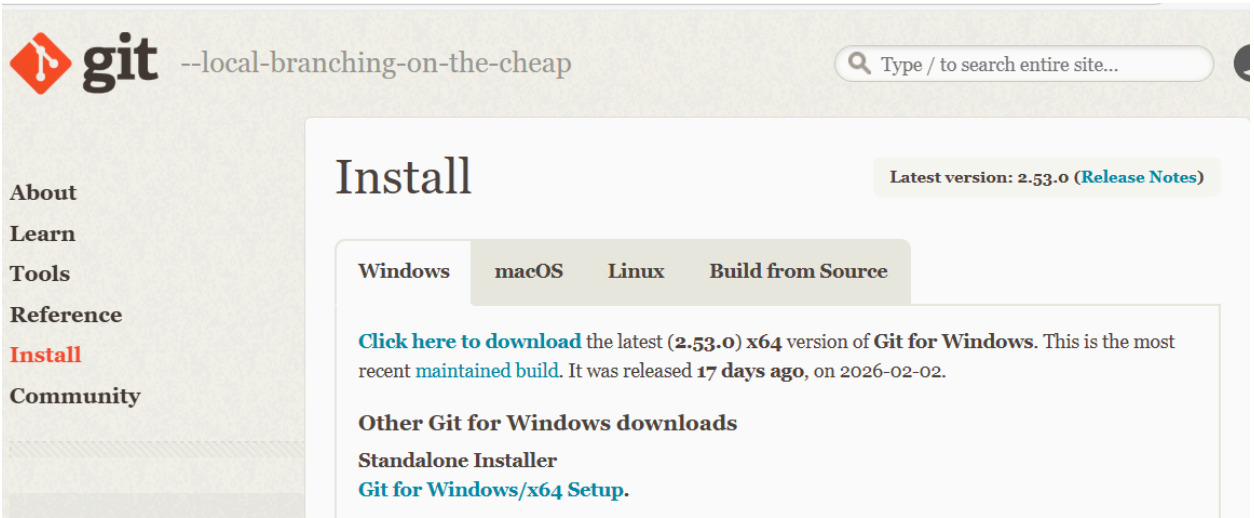
Install Git for Windows and Clone a Repository

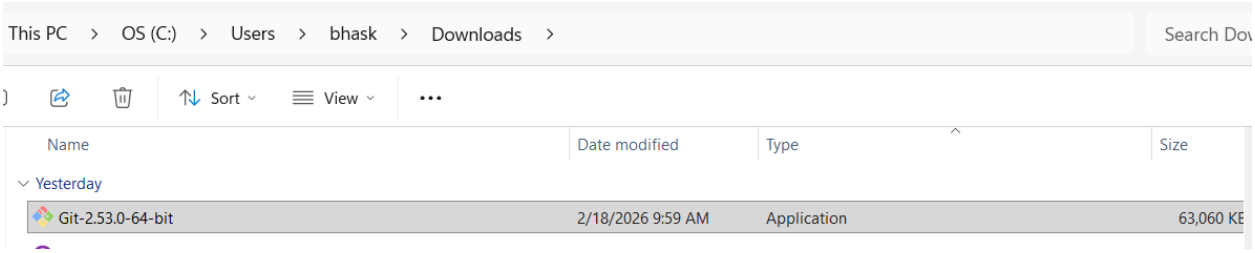
This procedure walks you through installing Git for Windows using the default settings and cloning a repository from GitHub.

1. Download Git for Windows

1. Open a web browser.
2. Go to https://git-scm.com/install.
3. Click **Windows**.
4. Click here to download the latest (2.53.0) x64 version of Git for Windows.



5. Save the installer file to your computer.



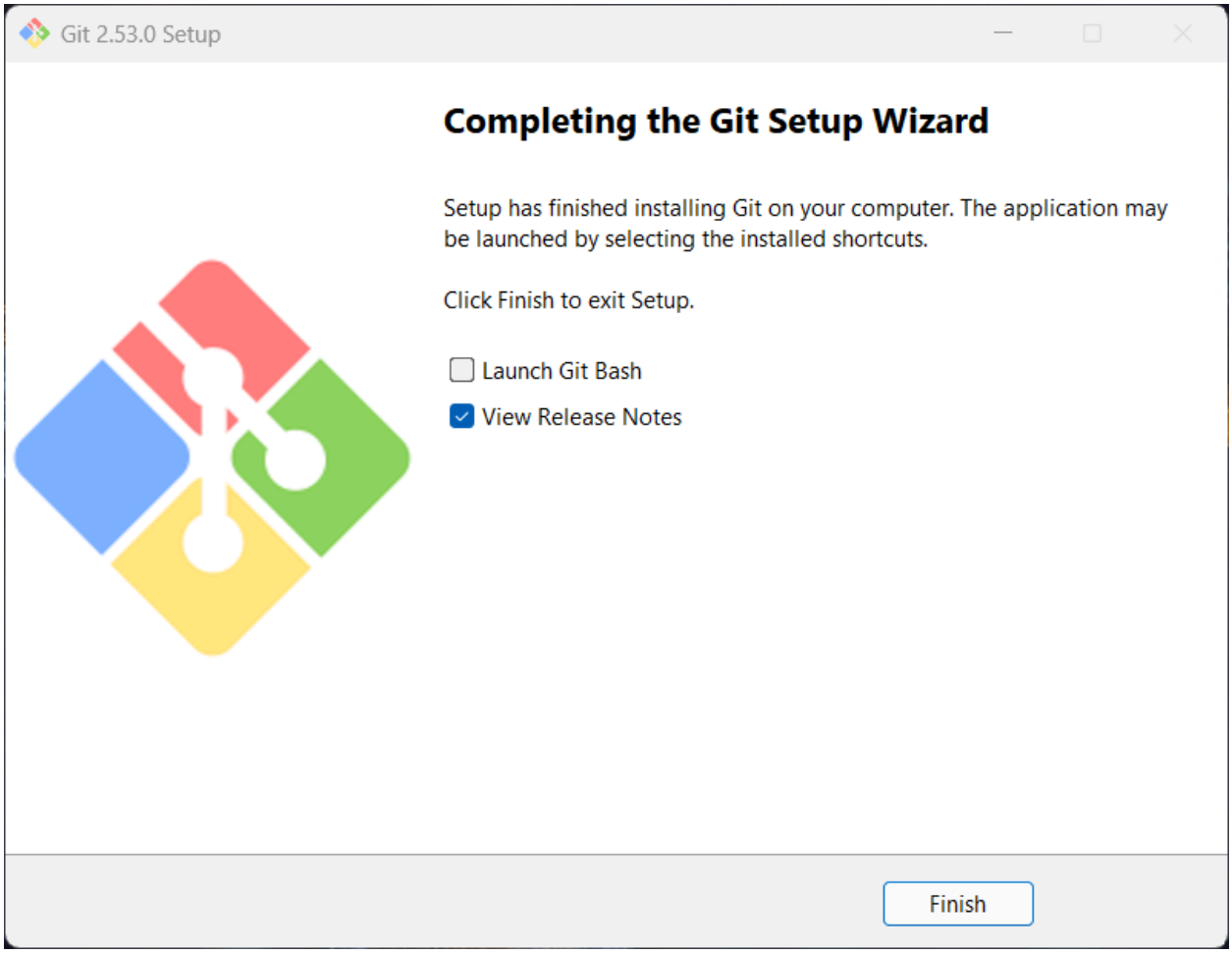
2. Install Git

1. Double-click the downloaded installer file.
2. If prompted by User Account Control, select **Yes**.

3. In the setup wizard, select **Next** on each screen.
    - Accept all default settings.

    For detailed screenshots of each step, see **Appendix A**.

4. Select **Install**.
5. When the installation completes, select **Finish**.

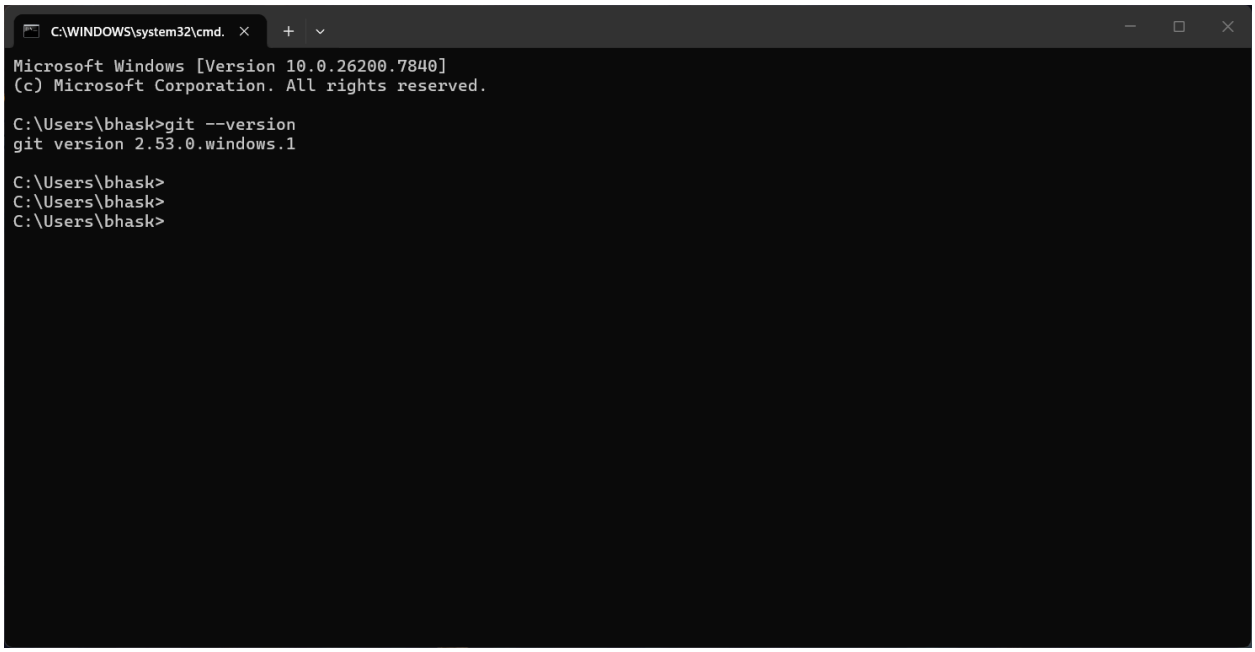


Git is now installed on your system.

3. Verify the Installation

1. Open **Command Prompt**.
2. Type:
   `git --version`
3. Press **Enter**.

You should see the installed Git version number.



4. Clone a Repository

1. In **Command Prompt**, navigate to the folder where you want to store the repository. For example:
   `cd C:\Users\YourUserName\Documents`
2. Run the following command:
   `git clone https://github.com/username/repository.git`

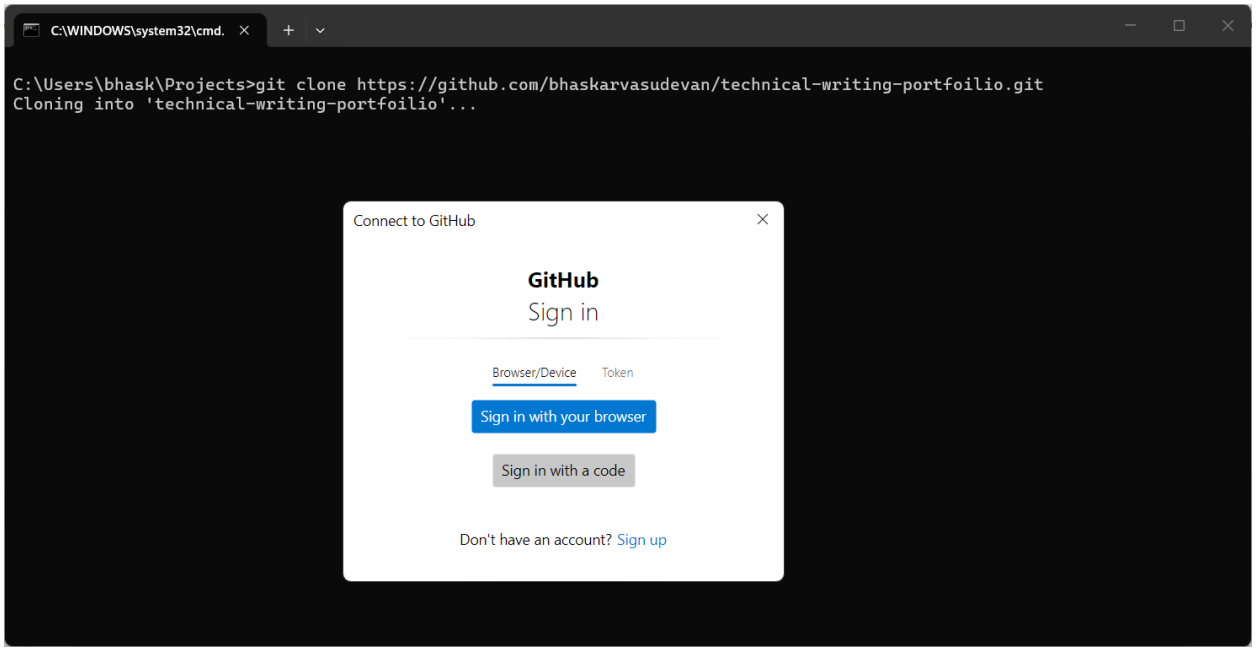
   Replace the URL with your repository's URL.
   `Example:`
   `git clone https://github.com/bhaskarvasudevan/technical-writing-portfolio.git`

5. Authenticate with GitHub (First-Time Access)

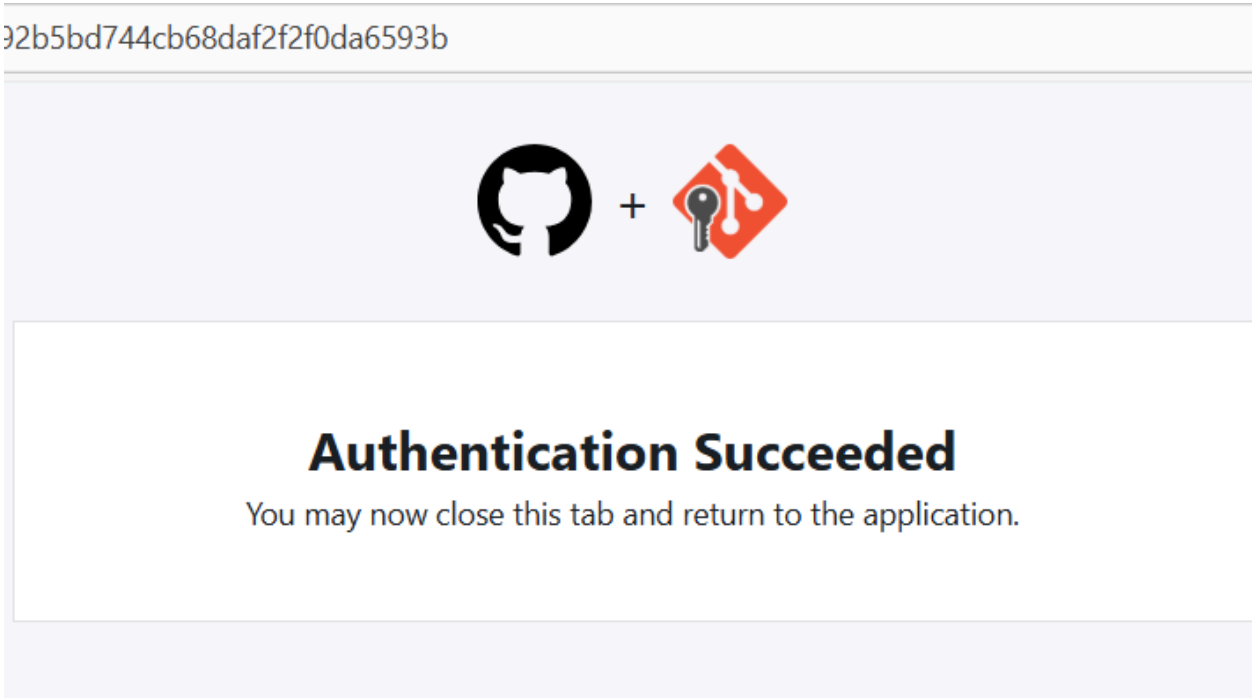
The first time you run `git clone` against a private repository on GitHub, Git prompts you to authenticate.

You might see:

- A browser window open for sign-in, or
- A prompt asking for your GitHub credentials



Sign in with your GitHub account and complete the authentication process.



After successful authentication:

- Git downloads the repository.

- A new folder is created with the repository name.

Result

You have:

- Installed Git for Windows
- Verified the installation
- Cloned a GitHub repository
- Authenticated with GitHub (if required)

Appendix A: Git for Windows Installation Screenshots

This appendix shows each screen in the Git for Windows installation wizard using default settings.

Figure A-1. License Agreement screen

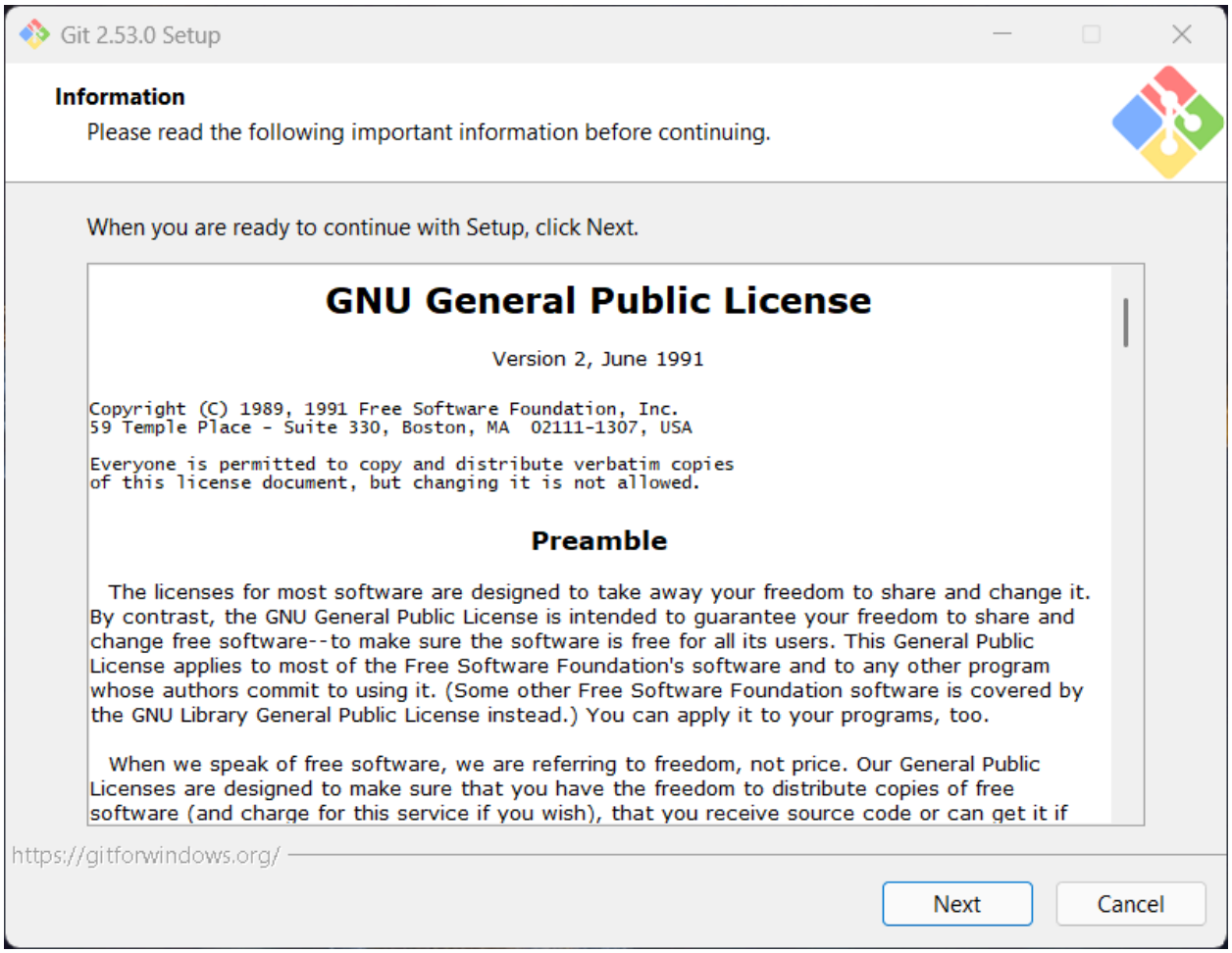


Figure A-2. Select Destination Location screen

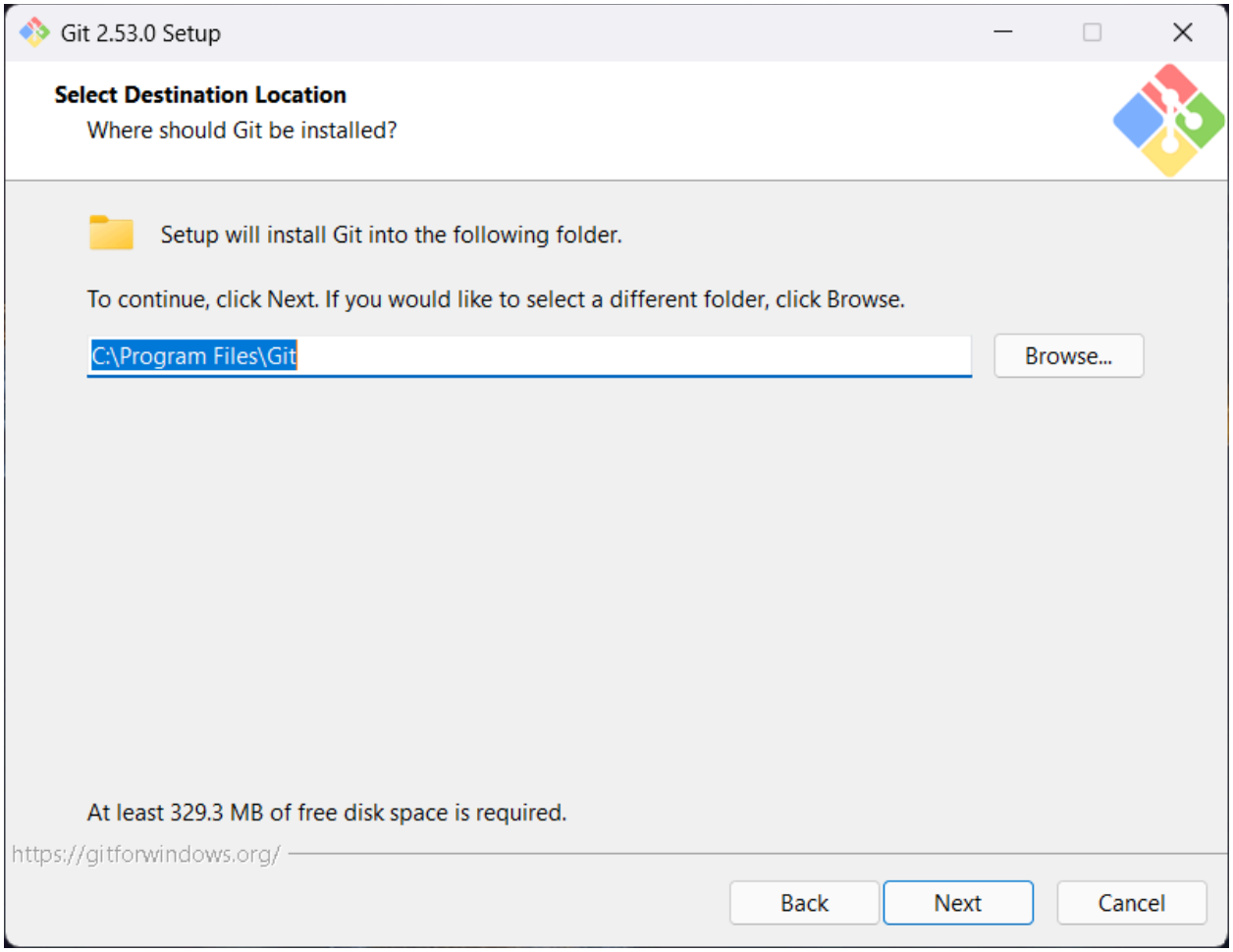


Figure A-3. Select Components screen

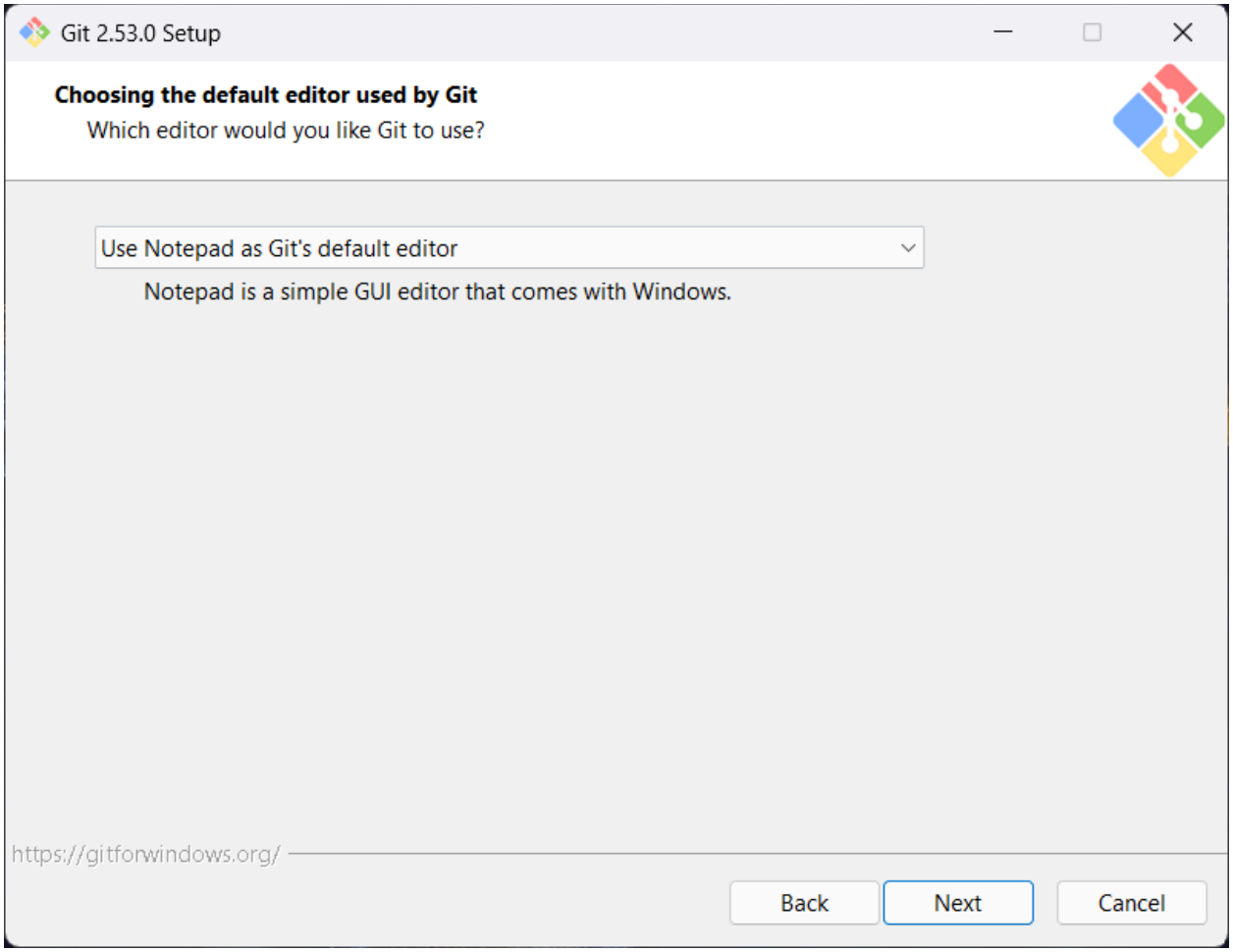


Figure A-4. Adjusting your initial branch name (**master** or **main**) screen

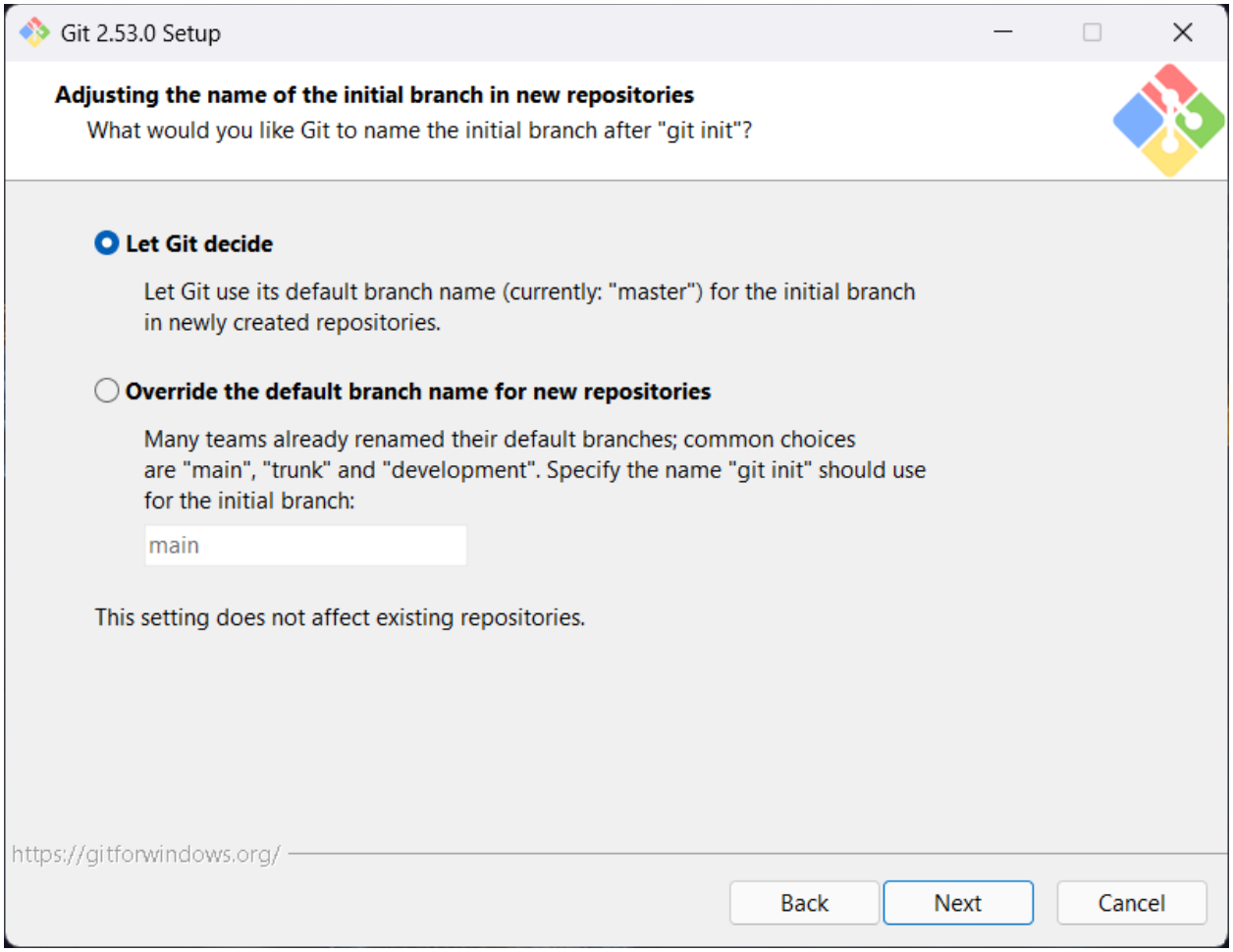


Figure A-5. Adjusting your PATH environment screen

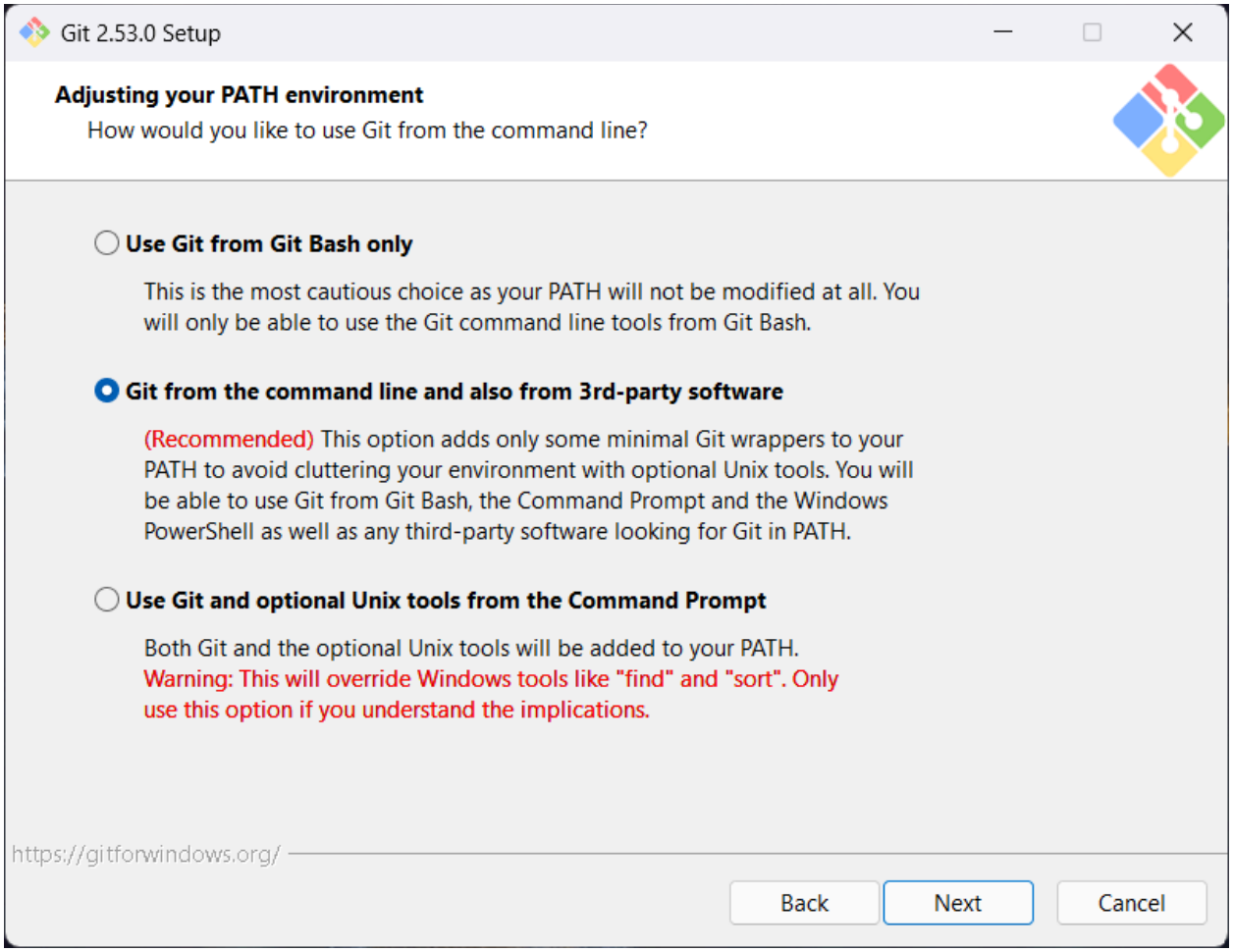


Figure A-6. Choosing the SSH executable screen

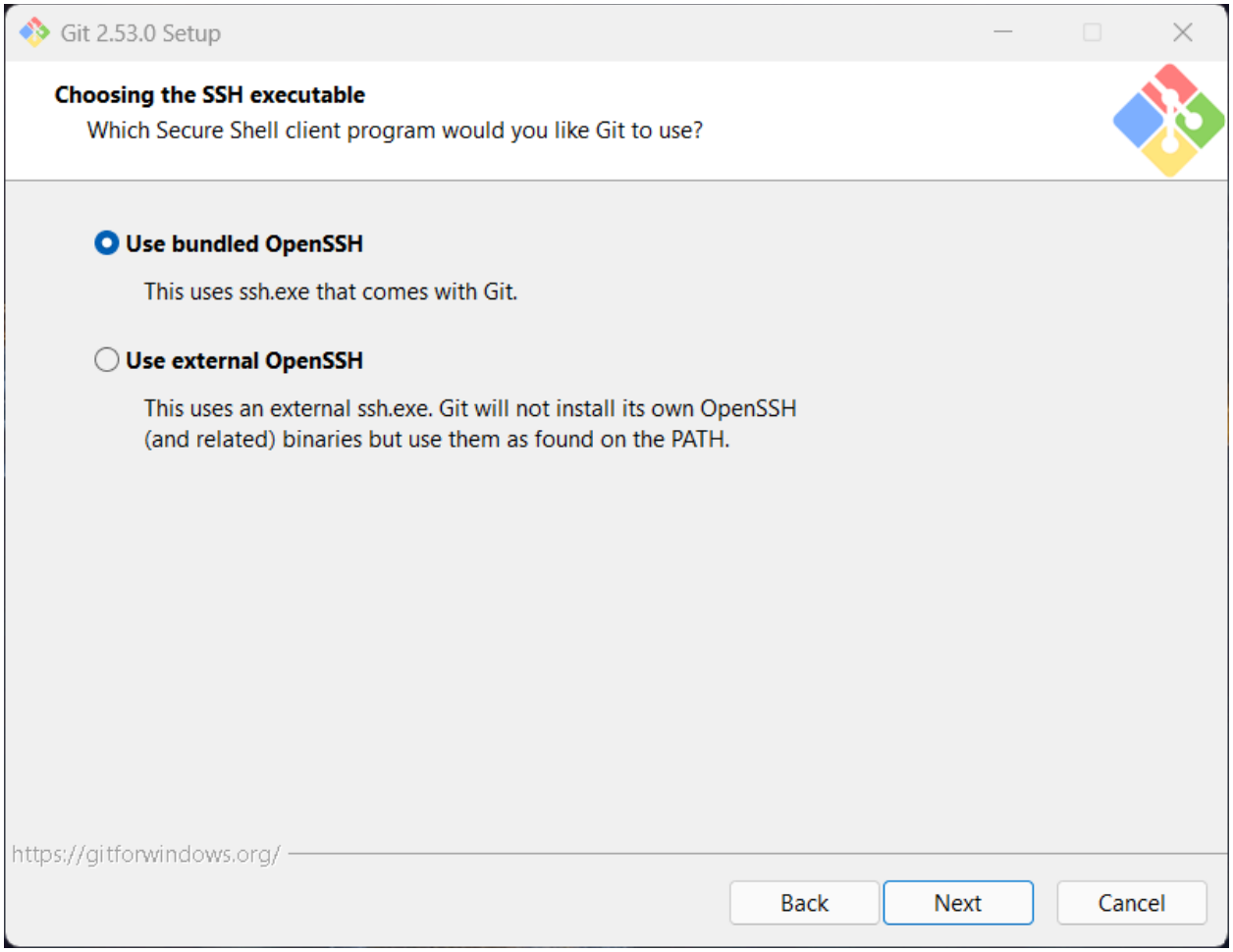


Figure A-7. Choosing HTTPS transport backend screen

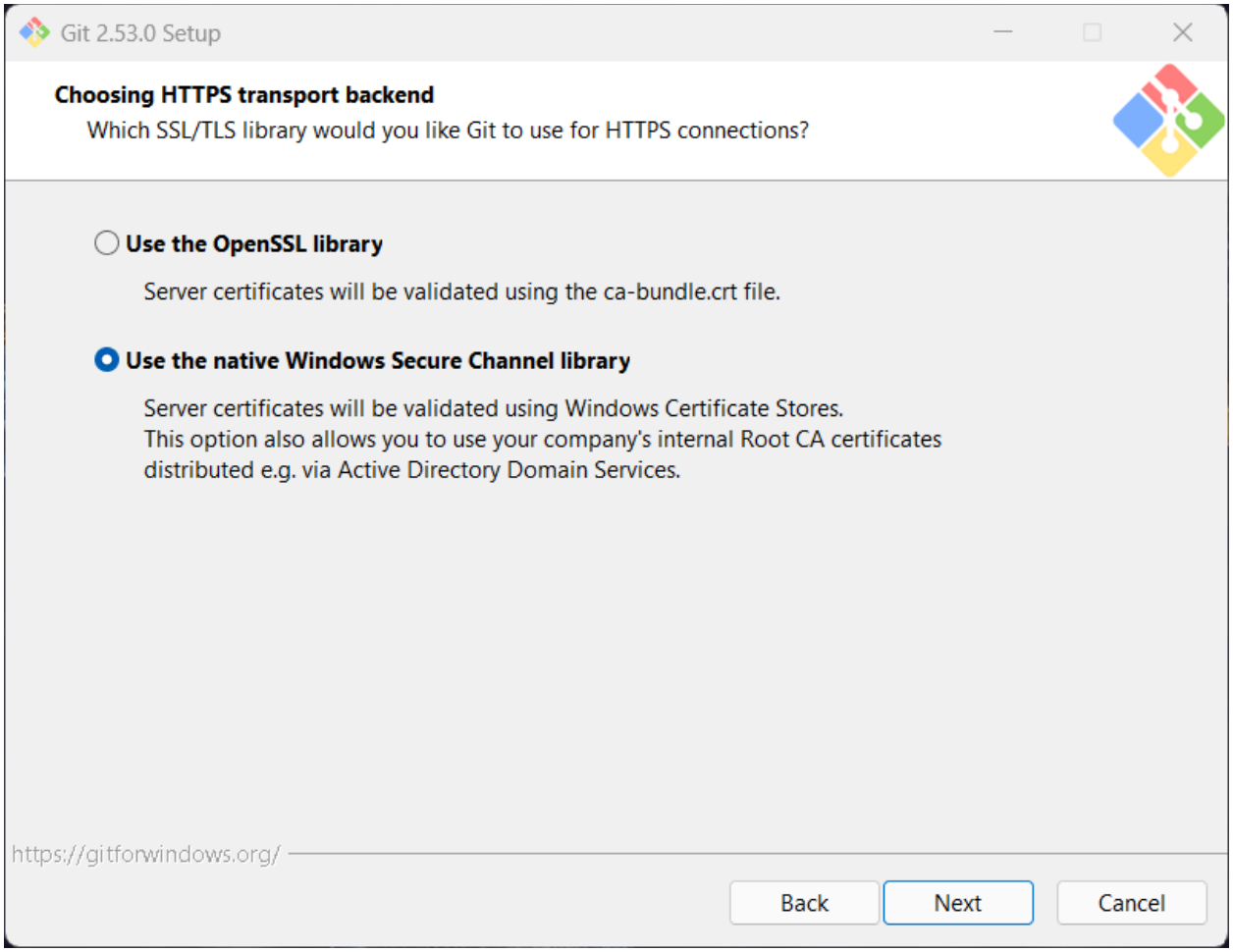


Figure A-8. Configuring the line ending conversions

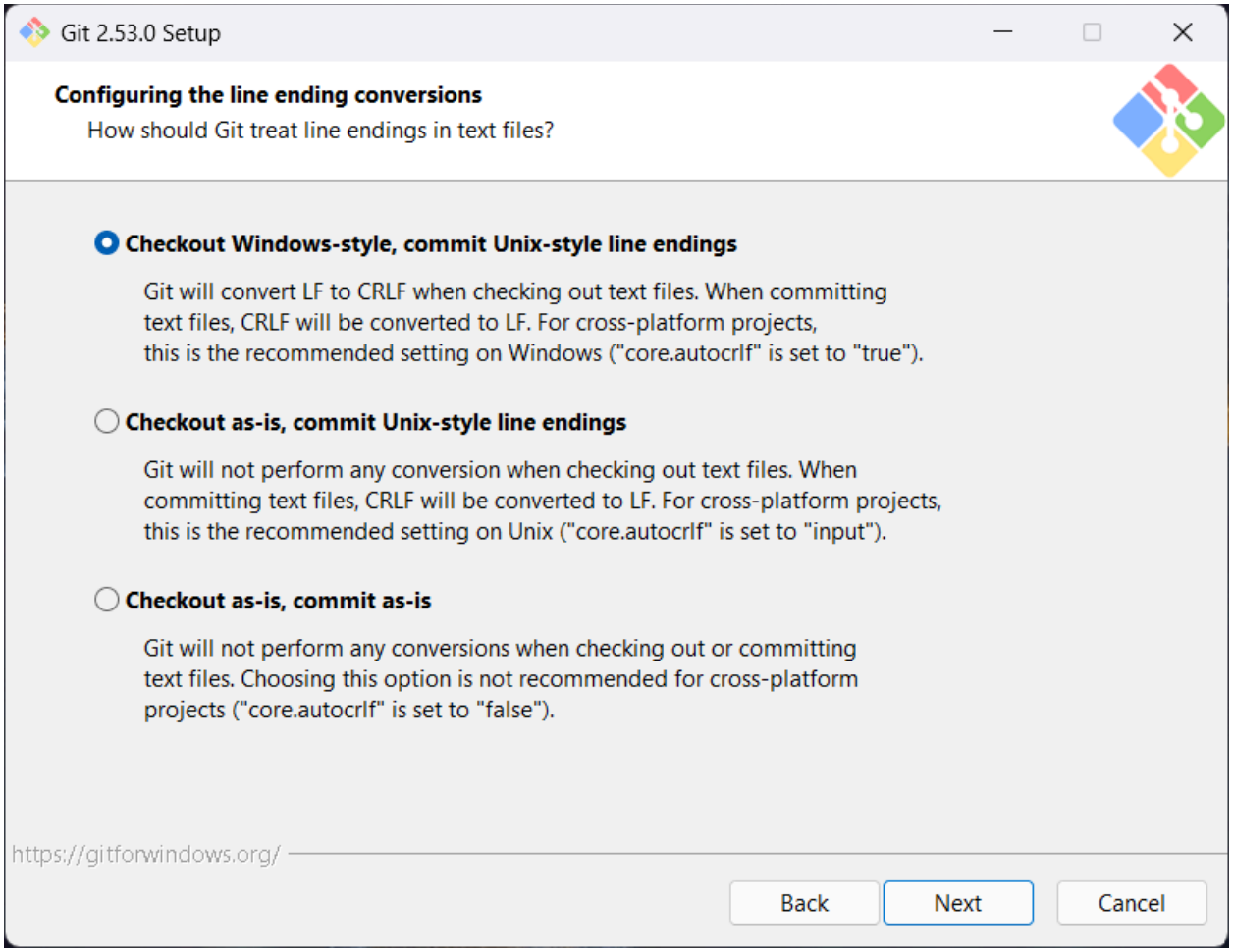


Figure A-9. Configuring the terminal emulator to use with Git Bash screen

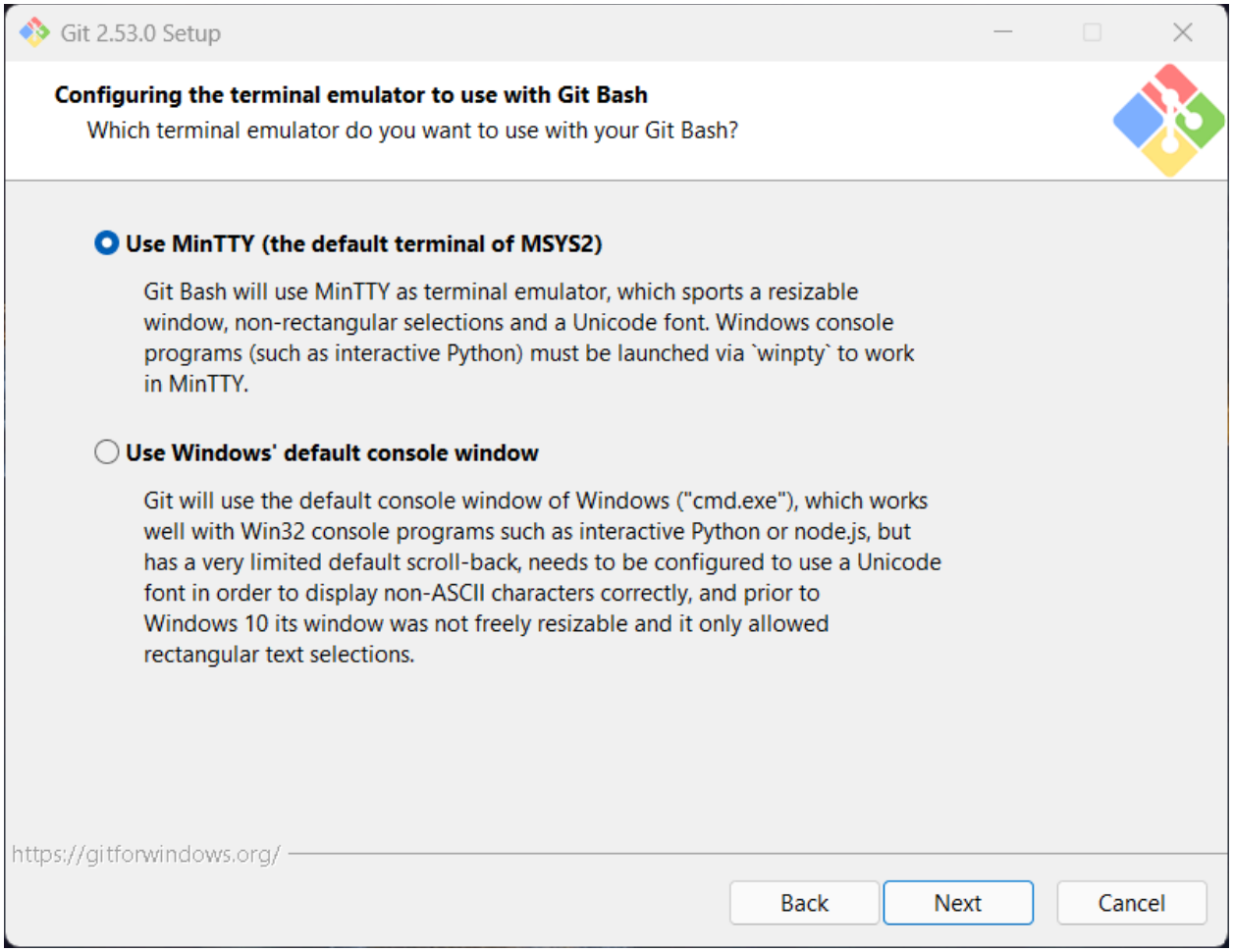


Figure A-10. Choose the default behavior of **git pull** screen

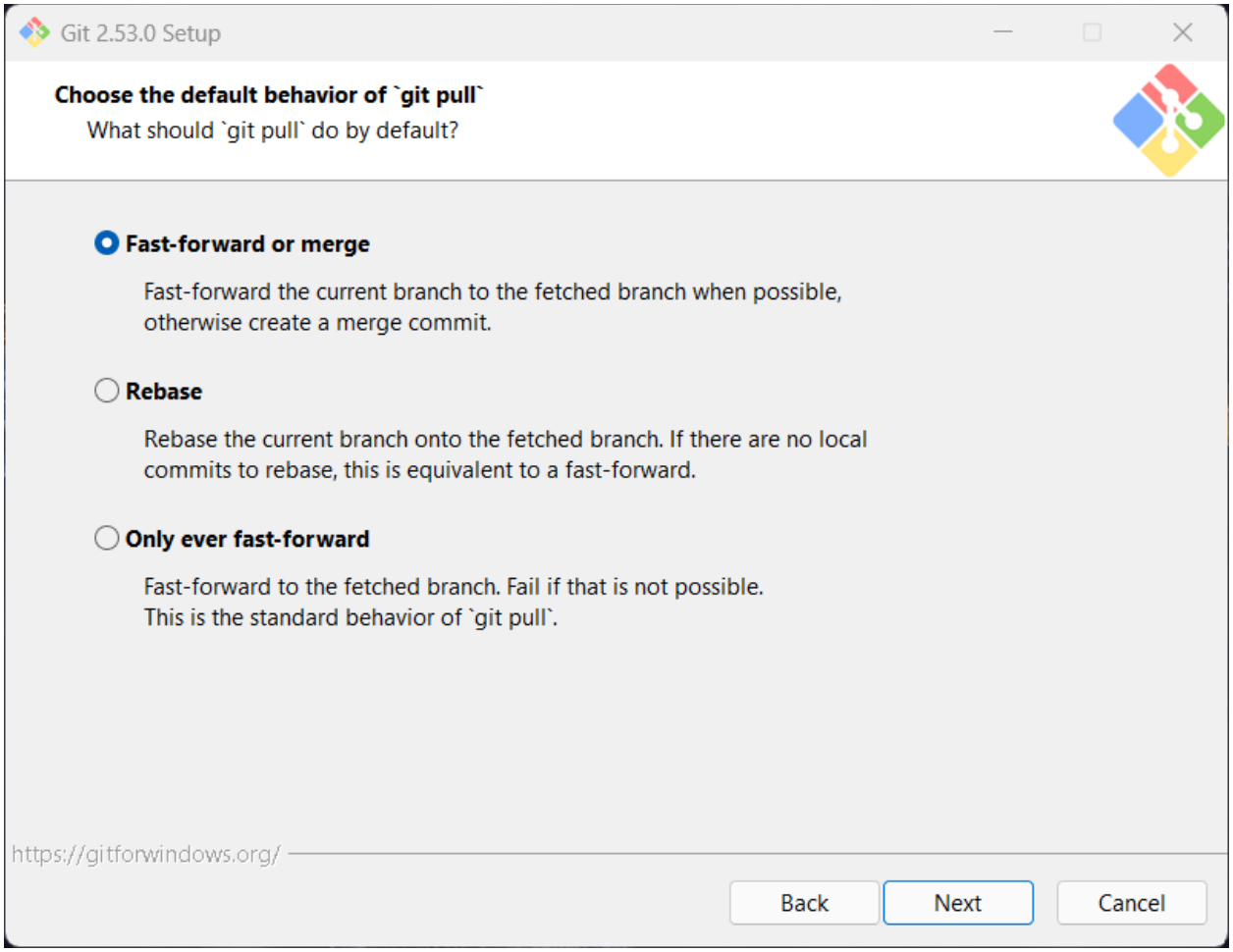


Figure A-11. Choose a credential helper screen

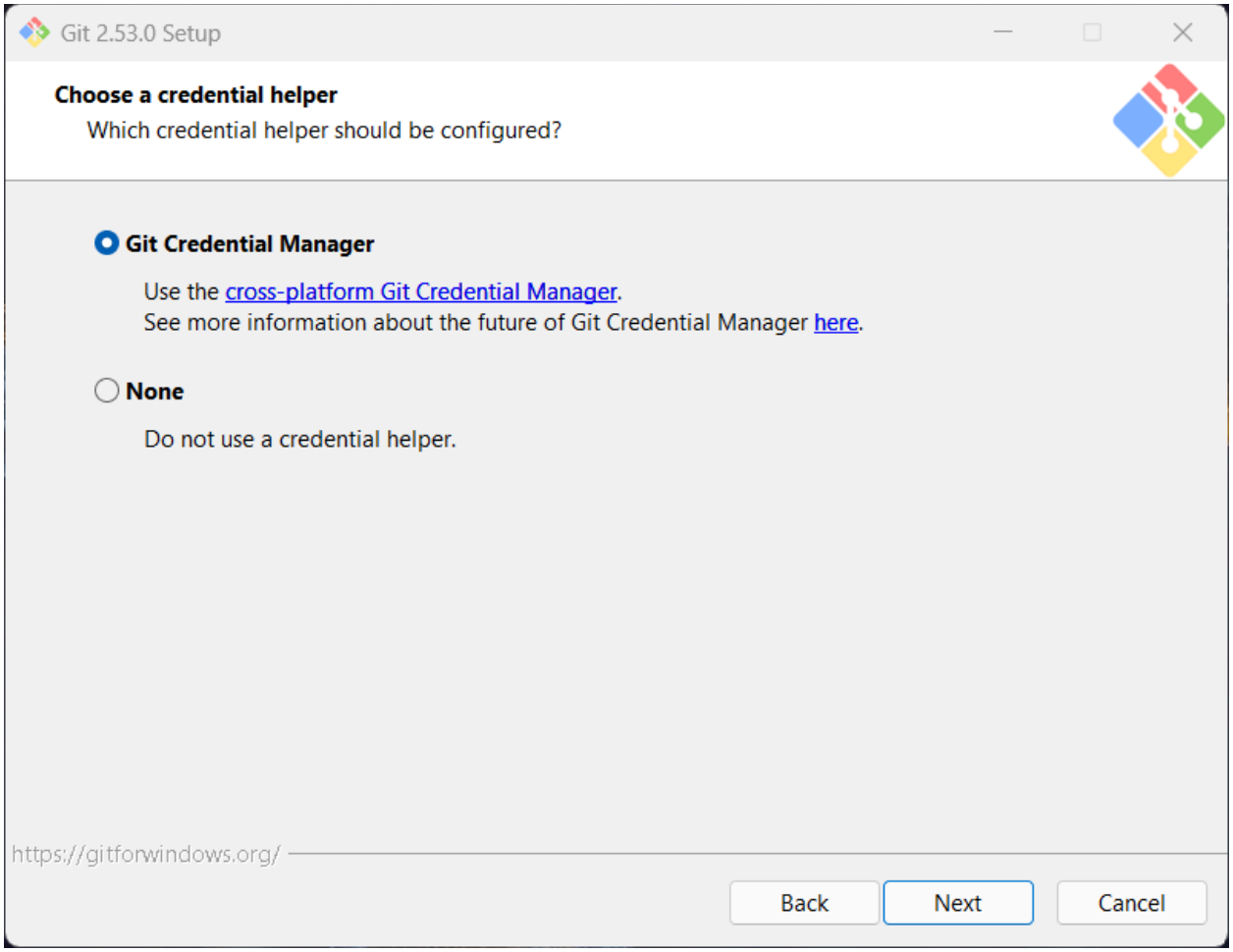

Git 2.53.0 Setup
Choose a credential helper
Which credential helper should be configured?
Git Credential Manager
Use the cross-platform Git Credential Manager.
See more information about the future of Git Credential Manager here.
None
Do not use a credential helper.
https://gitforwindows.org/
Back
Next
Cancel

Figure A-11. Configuring extra options screen

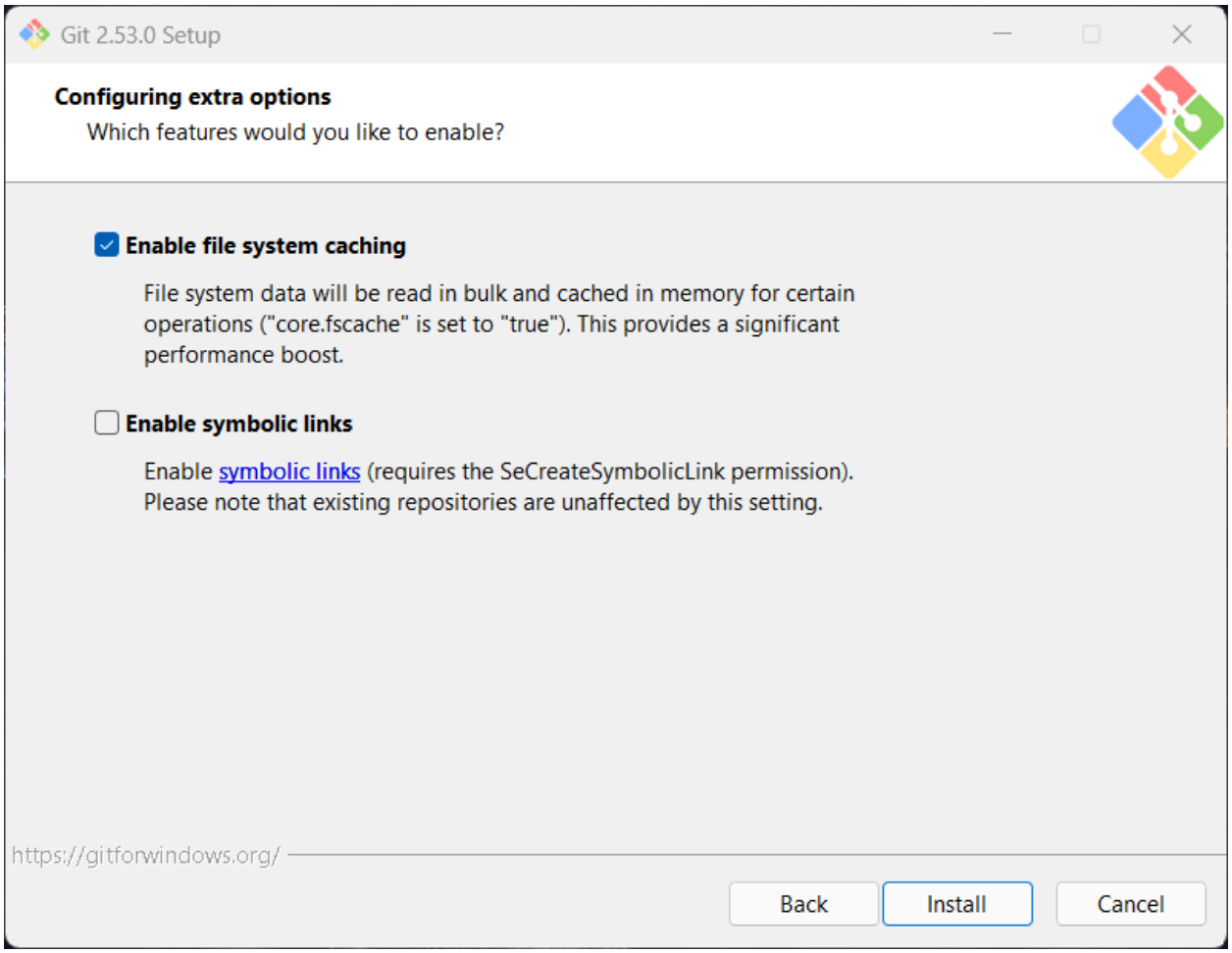


Figure A-12. Ready to Install screen

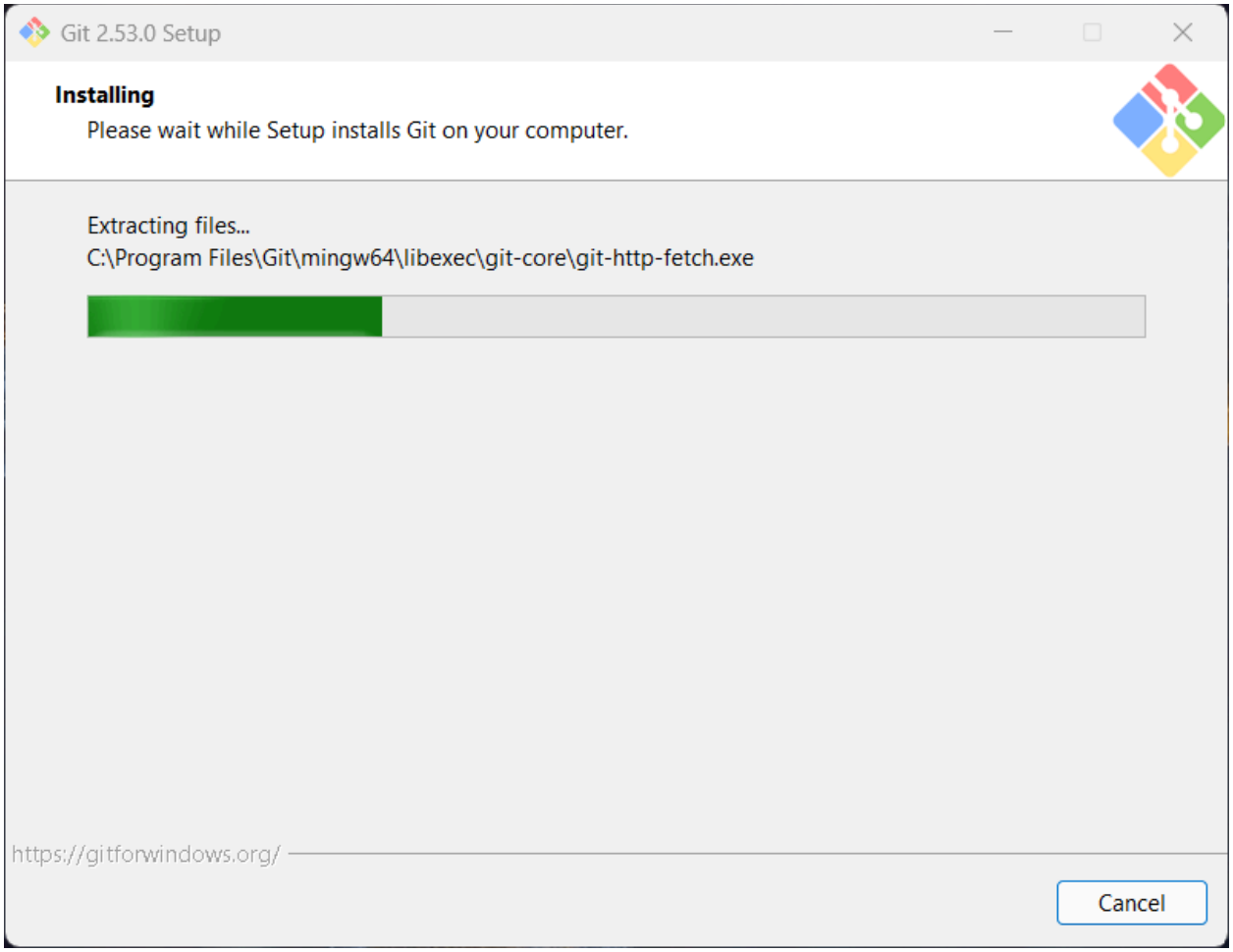
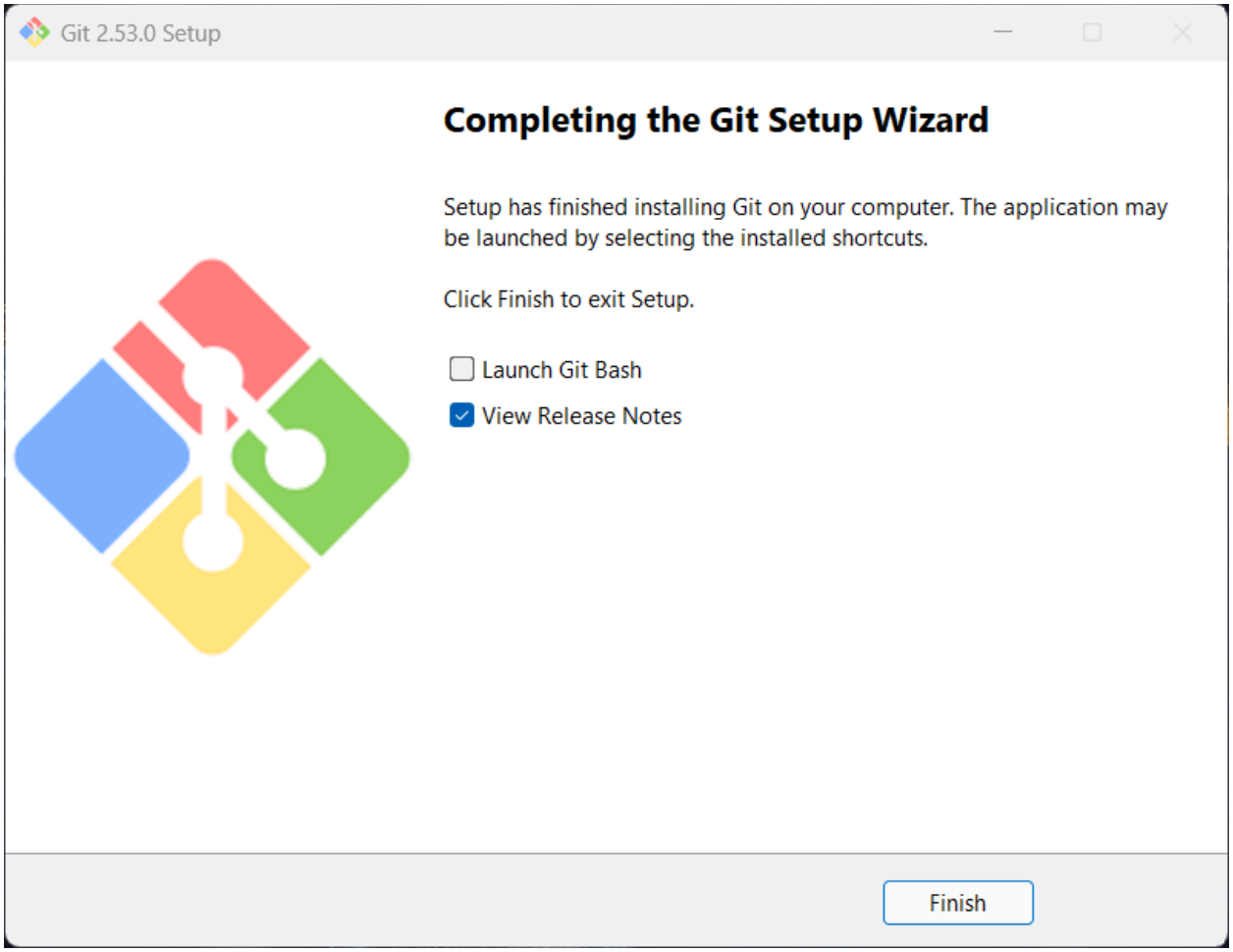


Figure A-13. Completing the Git Setup Wizard


Git 2.53.0 Setup
Completing the Git Setup Wizard
Setup has finished installing Git on your computer. The application may be launched by selecting the installed shortcuts.
Click Finish to exit Setup.
Launch Git Bash
View Release Notes
Finish